📖 Debut user manual

Last updated 7 Nov 2026. Everything you need, from creating your account to inviting a team. Jump to: Sign up · Find your way around · First week · Adding & editing · UTM & Experiments · Calendar · Mood boards · Team & roles · Clients · Plans · Colours · Security · Shortcuts · Troubleshooting

1. Sign up (about 2 minutes)

1. Open **Create account**. Enter your name, work email, a workspace / company name (up to 80 characters; your team sees it at the top of the app) and your industry.
2. Leave **Load my industry starter kit** ticked to get personas, a launch checklist, key dates and news feeds for your industry. You can add or delete all of it later.
3. Choose a password. It needs **at least 8 characters, one UPPERCASE letter and one special character** (for example ! @ # $ %). A strength bar and checklist below the box turn green as you meet each rule, and the 👁 icon shows or hides what you typed. Easy-to-guess passwords (your email name, “password”, “123456”, long repeats) are refused.
4. Tick the Terms / Privacy box and press **Create account**. You land on your Home screen with a 14-day trial of every feature. After that you keep the **Free forever** plan; nothing is deleted. No card needed.
5. **Verify your email** from the link we send (the yellow banner has a Resend button). AI features and some settings need a verified email.

Were you invited? Use the link in your invitation email. The page shows the company and your role, your email is already filled in and locked, and you only set a name and password. **Already have a Debut account?** Log in with the same email and accept the invite: the company workspace is added next to your own free one, which stays exactly as it is. Switch between them from the workspace name at the top left.

2. Find your way around

WHERE	WHAT IT DOES
🏠 **Home** (top left)	Your dashboard: a greeting, set-up progress, the “Today” list (what is overdue or due), counts of everything, what publishes this week, budget, pipeline and funnel.
Side menu	Grouped by topic (Strategy, Content, Campaigns, Promotions & Events, Content Ops, Growth, Intelligence, Workspace). Click a heading to open or close it. Hover over any page and click its ☆ to **pin** it to the top of the menu under “⭐ Pinned”; click ★ to unpin. A 🔒 means the item belongs to a higher plan.
Search box (top bar)	Type and press Enter to search all your records at once. The ✕ in the box (or the Esc key) clears it. On the results page, **✕ Close search** takes you back. Press `Ctrl` + `K` (`⌘` + `K` on Mac) to jump to the box from anywhere.

+ Create	Starts a new content item, task, campaign, lead or key date in a pop-up form, or opens mood boards and the Idea Bank. Which options you see depends on your role.
🌙 / ☀️	Switches between light and dark mode. Debut remembers your choice on this device (and follows your phone or computer setting the first time).
❓ · 🔔	Help and guides; your notifications (assignments, mentions, approvals).
Your name (top right)	Profile, Send feedback and Log out. Your role (Owner, Admin, Lead, Manager, Creator, Viewer) shows under your name.
On a phone	A bar at the bottom gives Home, Calendar, a big + (new content), Tasks and Menu (the side menu). Tables turn into easy-to-read cards.

3. Your first week

1. **Day 1:** follow the "Get started" checklist on Home: write a GTM plan, add content to the calendar, create a mood board, add an influencer, capture a lead, invite a teammate, verify your email. The bar at the top of Home fills as you go.
2. **Day 2:** open Strategy > Brand Kit and add your colours, fonts and voice. In Account you can scan an existing brand deck to pull them in.
3. **Day 3:** fill the Calendar for the next 2 weeks (use the Idea Bank when stuck).
4. **Day 4:** set a target in KPIs and log the first numbers.
5. **Day 5:** invite your team and set the right roles.
6. **Every day:** open Home and work through the "Today" list. Once a week check Growth > Marketing Health for gaps.

4. Adding and editing things

- Every "New" and "Edit" opens a **pop-up form** over the page, so you never lose your place. Save returns you to the same page.
- Each form starts with what it is for. Fields marked * are required; a field's hint is shown under it. Some fields allow several choices (for example an influencer's platforms are tick-boxes).
- Lists show a **Budget used** bar for campaigns and promotions; it turns red when spend passes the budget.
- Lists have **Export to Excel** and a blank Excel template, so you can fill in bulk data and import it. Drag the ⠿ handle to reorder cards on boards.
- Deleting asks you to confirm. Everything you do is recorded in the Activity log (owners/admins can export it as CSV).

Tracking links (UTM Builder) and Experiments

- **UTM Builder** (Campaigns): press + **New UTM link**. A pop-up asks for a label, the page you are linking to, where the link will be posted (source, for example instagram), the channel type (medium, for example social) and the campaign. The finished link builds itself as you type; press **Copy** and paste it into your post, ad or email. Saved links are listed with a Copy button.
- **Experiments** (Campaigns) is for A/B tests: change **one thing**, measure **one number**. Fill in: **Hypothesis** ("If we [change], then [result], because [reason]"), **Channel**, **Success metric** (the one number you will watch, for example saves or click-through rate), **Variant A** (what you do today), **Variant B** (the one thing you change), **Status** (Idea, Running, Concluded) and, once finished, **Result / decision** (what happened and whether you keep, drop or retest it).

5. Calendar

- Shows content by publish date and your key dates (festivals, sales, events) in orange. Use ◀ ▶ for months and the channel filter at the top.
- Press + in any day to add content for that date. On a computer, hover a day to see shortcuts to the Idea Bank and Mood Boards.
- **Drag a chip** to another day to reschedule it.
- Use the private link under the title to see the calendar in Google, Apple or Outlook Calendar. Keep it secret; press Reset link if it leaks.

6. Mood boards

- Start from a **template** (product launch, festive, social campaign and more) or a blank board. Drop images, add colour swatches, notes and links, and drag everything into place.
- Buttons on a board: **Share**, **Rename**, **Duplicate** and **Save colours** (adds the board's colours to your Brand Kit).
- **Share** gives two kinds of link: a *team link* (people must sign in) and a *public view-only link* that anyone can open without an account. You can make a fresh link or turn the public link off at any time. Public pages are hidden from search engines.

7. Team and roles

ROLE	CAN DO	CAN INVITE

Owner	Everything, including plan, billing and deleting the workspace. One per workspace.	Admin, Lead, Manager, Creator, Viewer, Client
Admin	Everything except ownership. Manages team, settings and brand.	Lead, Manager, Creator, Viewer, Client
Lead	Team hub, approvals and delegation for a group. Needs a Team or Agency plan (or the trial).	Manager, Creator, Viewer, Client
Manager	Plans, campaigns, content, leads and tasks day to day.	Creator, Viewer, Client
Creator	Freelancer view: only content items, assets, content orders, tasks, reference links, the calendar, mood boards and the Idea Bank. Never sees prices, margins, billing or the team.	nobody
Viewer	Read-only, plus comments and their own profile.	nobody
Client	Only the Client portal: sees their own work, approves or comments.	nobody

You can only give roles ranked **below** your own. Use the lowest role that does the job.

Inviting people

1. Open **Team & roles** > **Invite someone**.
2. **Several people, one role:** paste as many emails as you like (separated by commas, spaces or new lines), choose the role and press invite. Each gets their own link.
3. **Different roles:** download the **CSV template**, fill in email and role (and client name for clients), upload it. Rows with problems are listed with the reason; good rows still go through.
4. Pending invites show on the page. **Revoke** cancels one; it is written to the Activity log. Invites stop at your plan’s seat limit.

8. Clients and the portal

Invite someone with the **Client** role and type their client name exactly as you use it in the “Client” field of your content. They get a clean portal with their own content to **approve, request changes on or comment** on, plus their campaigns. They cannot see other clients, prices, your team or any other page. Use **Preview** next to a client on the Team page to see what they see. You can also send a read-only **Client report** link.

9. Plans and billing

Every new workspace gets 14 days of the full feature set, then moves to **Free forever** unless you upgrade. Nothing is deleted when you downgrade; paid-only items just show a 🔒.

PLAN	PRICE / MONTH	SEATS	AI CREDITS / MONTH	RECORDS	MOOD BOARDS
Free	Free	1	5	100	3
Free trial	Free	5	40	2,000	Unlimited
Starter	₹999	1	40	1,500	20
Team	₹3,999	5	250	10,000	Unlimited
Agency	₹9,999	15	1000	50,000	Unlimited

Prices exclude GST. On the Plan page, what changes compared with your current plan is highlighted (credits, seats, features), with ✓ for included and × for not included. In demo mode no real payment is taken.

10. Make it yours: colours

Go to **Account**. Pick a **primary colour** (your brand colour) and a **secondary colour**. The secondary colour is yours to choose: it colours buttons, the active menu item, your avatar, the Create button, the dashboard banner and highlights, blended with your primary. Press **Use auto** to let Debut choose a matching lighter shade. Upload your logo in the same place. The preview strip shows the combination before you press **Apply**.

11. Account and security

- **Password:** 8+ characters, one capital, one special character; change it under Account. Resetting uses an emailed link.
- **Two-factor login:** turn it on in Account with an authenticator app. Save your **recovery codes**; one of them lets you in if you lose your phone.
- **Verify email:** unlocks AI features and sensitive settings.
- **Your data:** "Export data" downloads everything as spreadsheets; owners can delete the workspace under Account.

12. News, Market Pulse and AI

- **Latest Updates** shows live news from your feeds. If your server cannot reach the internet it shows a saved snapshot dated 1 Nov 2026 instead, and you can search it.
- **Market Pulse** follows trends, videos and competitors for your industry (competitor watch-list size depends on your plan).
- **AI Studio** drafts calendars, plans, blogs and reports. Each use costs credits from your monthly allowance. Debut does not post to social platforms for you: you post, then mark the item Published.

13. Shortcuts

DO THIS	TO GET THIS
`Ctrl` / `⌘` + `K`	Jump to the search box
`Esc`	Clear the search box, or close a pop-up form
Drag a calendar chip	Reschedule to another day
Drag ⠿ on a card	Reorder
Bottom + on phones	New content in one tap

14. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
No verification or invite email	Check spam. Use Resend link on the banner. Pending invites can be revoked and sent again.
“Too many attempts”	Sign-up, login and reset are rate limited for safety (for example 10 sign-ups per hour from one network). Wait and try again.
Password refused	Add a capital letter and a special character, avoid your email name or common words.
Menu item is locked 🔒 or a button says upgrade	It belongs to a higher plan, or you reached a limit (seats, records, boards, AI credits). Open Plan to compare.
I can’t see a page my colleague can	Your role does not include it. Ask an owner or admin to change your role.

Lost my phone (two-factor)	Use a recovery code on the code screen, or contact us.
News says “could not load”	The live feed could not be reached. The saved snapshot is shown; try again later.
Anything else	Profile menu > Send feedback (it includes the page you were on), or the Contact page.